

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Have You Ever Seen A Whale?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 30

No.	Sentence
1	Georgie once saw a _____ while walking
2	Phil observed whales when travelling along the _____ in Patagonia
3	Whale watching has gained popularity in _____ of the world
4	Previously, people engaged in whaling to obtain _____
5	A global ban on commercial whale killing was introduced by the _____
6	Three countries still continue _____ today
7	The largest whale species can reach _____ in length
8	Blue and humpback whales are capable of swimming at speeds of _____
9	Early hunters used _____ for catching whales
10	This traditional method was frequently _____
11	In the _____, an inventor from Norway created a new weapon
12	The invention of the _____ dramatically changed whale hunting
13	Faster boats powered by _____ also contributed to increased whaling
14	By the 20th century, more than _____ whales had been killed
15	By the 1970s, only _____ remained
16	Greenpeace launched a campaign called _____
17	Recordings of whale sounds, known as the _____, became widely listened to

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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18	Activists positioned their boats between _____ and whales
19	Whales continue to face risks from _____ and plastic pollution
20	The hunting ban has been in effect for _____ so far

What is Phil's attitude when recalling the whale he saw in Patagonia?

- A He is impressed by the experience of seeing it in the wild
- B He feels indifferent because it was a common sight
- C He regrets not seeing more whales that day
- D He finds watching whales boring compared to other animals

What contrast does Georgie highlight about whale watching compared to past human activities?

- A Whale watching now supports whaling efforts
- B Whale watching is a non-harmful activity unlike whaling
- C Whale watching involves hunting whales for meat
- D Whale watching is illegal in many coastal areas

What can be inferred about the effect of the International Whaling Commission's ban?

- A It completely stopped all whaling activities worldwide
- B It led to increased whale hunting in Japan and Norway
- C It prevented extinction of many whale species
- D It was only effective for a few years after implementation

What does the phrase "turning point" mean in the context of Svend Foyn's invention?

- A The development of non-lethal whale hunting methods
- B When whale watching became more popular than whaling
- C A moment when whale populations began to recover
- D The start of a major change in whaling practices

What reasoning explains why whales "didn't stand a chance" after 1870?

- A Whales became slower and easier to catch
- B New technologies made hunting whales much easier
- C Hunters started protecting whale populations
- D Whales started migrating away from coastal areas

What attitude does Joe Roman express towards Greenpeace's role?

- A Neutral and merely descriptive about their activities
- B Praising their effective protection of whales
- C Uncertain about their impact on public opinions
- D Critical of their aggressive methods at sea

Which phrase best describes Greenpeace's use of media according to the transcript?

- A They struggled to gain media attention for whales
- B They cleverly used media to influence people's views
- C They relied on government media coverage exclusively
- D They avoided media and focused on direct action

What is the most likely reason that some whale species are still endangered today?

- A They continue to be hunted commercially in large numbers
- B Environmental threats like pollution and ocean acidification persist
- C Whale watching causes significant disturbance to their habitats
- D Whales naturally have very short lifespans and low reproduction rates

What is the main reason the moratorium on whaling is important today?

- A It temporarily halts hunting to help whale populations
- B It ensures whales will no longer face danger at all
- C It replaces older laws with permanent protections
- D It allows only small-scale, regulated whaling activities

Why is the vaquita whale surprising as the smallest species?

- A Because it is often mistaken for the largest whale
- B Because it is much smaller than what "pygmy" suggests
- C Because it lives in deep ocean areas rarely seen
- D Because 'pygmy' usually implies very large size